

Admin dashboard: UI/UX audit

Huchu schools vertical audit · Admin dashboard: UI/UX audit · admin/ui-ux.md · rendered 2026-09-15

Surface: the setup and master-data screens: `app/management/master-data/schools/{years,periods,classes,subjects,grading,identity}` with their `MasterDataShell`, `app/schools/{calendar,timetable,teachers,teachers/assignments,staff,imports,documents,transport,library,library/loans,boarding/hostels,notices,messages}`, and the components under `components/schools/{academics,classes,subjects,teachers,staff,timetable,imports,documents,transport,library,boarding,notices,messages}`. Audited from source and from `docs/screenshots/schools/{records-desktop,the-roll/03-classes,the-roll/04-teachers,teacher-hr-*,imports-*,visual-pass-*/01-timetable,visual-pass-*/01-teachers}`. Workflow companion: `workflows.md` in this folder.

Rules applied: the platform UX playbook, the design-system rules, the campus canvas law, screen contract and states doc, `.impeccable.md`, `SPEC.md`. Evidence with line numbers in `../reference/backoffice-ui-ux-evidence.md` §2.

1. Verdict in one paragraph

The setup screens work but are hard to reach and hard to scan. The six master-data pages sit behind two navigation rails and a description line, then repeat their counts in chips and tabs, stack their filters vertically with the create button floating between them, and add a third control row for the table's own search. The timetable, the one screen that should be a grid, never shows one: three header buttons with the primary greyed, filters over two rows, and an empty state that explains what a lesson is. Teachers and guardians lists clip their actions column off the right edge. Title Case and ALL CAPS labels appear on documents, notices, boarding and years. Native date inputs render in the browser's locale on every date field. The imports wizard has the best copy in the module and then grows down the page instead of advancing. The identity settings page is the one place that gates its controls by role and explains it; nothing else copied it. Since this was written the six master-data pages have become reachable from the school rail through a Setup band, though they still open in the Management shell with its own rail, its Title Case title and its description line; the teachers list has lost its repeated "Find the employee" button, its Title Case and its second name, and both it and the guardians list put their row verbs in a menu; documents, notices, years, allocations and leave name themselves once in sentence case and the notices rationale card is gone; library loans has an app-bar title of its own; and `app/schools` has route-level loading, error and not-found states with skeletons that mirror the real layouts. The stacked filters, the duplicated chips, the timetable with no grid, the native date inputs and the missing phone renderers are all as described below.

Runtime check (14 September 2026)

Verified on the seeded St Marys tenant as the head (see `../reference/runtime-verification.md`). Confirmed at runtime: the master-data pages are absent from the school sidebar; the classes, timetable and teachers screens render as described, with "Find the employee" on every teacher row. Not reproduced: the clipped Actions column on the teachers table.

Revised on 15 September 2026, after the eighteen commits that implemented against this audit. A finding that is now closed keeps its description and gains a sentence saying what closed it; a finding this audit got

wrong says so and gives the true position; everything else stands as written.

2. Screen-by-screen

Route	Component	Contract violations	Friction	Role awareness	Phone	Severity
/management/master-data/schools/years	schools-years-content.tsx → schools-calendar-content.tsx, school-days-content.tsx	MasterDataShell title plus description; two CreateButtons per tab; "Holidays & Events" ampersand and Title Case, fixed: the view reads "Holidays and events", while the shell's own "Years and Terms" and its description stand	Terms one at a time; "Make current" with no confirm	RecordActions gated	renderer present	P1
/management/master-data/schools/classes	schools-classes-content.tsx	PageHeading plus description; chips and tabs both show Classes 6 / Streams 0; filters stacked, "New class" floating, then a third row of Search, Search, Columns, Export; Capacity renders "-" not "—"	Streams as a second tab rather than rows under their class	gated	present	P1
/management/master-data/schools/subjects	schools-subjects-content.tsx	Same shape; two primaries "Add the standard subjects" and "New subject"	Pass mark 50 with no %; Classes count not a link	gated	present	P1
/management/master-data/schools/periods	school-day-content.tsx	Same shape; ?view=rooms deep link (good)	N dialogs for N periods; no "generate periods"	gated	present	P2
/management/master-data/schools/grading	grading-content.tsx	Same shape; duplicates the windows table owned by /schools/results/publish	"Make default" with no confirm	gated	present	P2
/management/master-data/schools/identity	identity-settings-content.tsx, school-custom-fields-panel.tsx	Settings shell (good); "Read-only for your role" alert is the pattern the rest should copy; explanatory paragraph under every control	Save bar is not the design-system save bar; no dirty indicator	gated (the only one)	not checked	P2
/schools/calendar	school-calendar-page-content.tsx → school-days-content.tsx	PageChrome (good); two CreateButtons; native date inputs	Edit is delete and recreate; the API has since gained a PATCH that this screen does not call	gated	present	P2

Route	Component	Contract violations	Friction	Role awareness	Phone	Severity
/schools/staff	school-staff-content.tsx	PageChrome, band, TableControls (compliant); HR codes mapped to school words (good)	"End employment" only in the row menu; no bulk	gated	no renderer, five-column table at 390px	P1
/schools/teachers	schools-teachers-content.tsx (1,027 lines)	PageHeading plus caption duplicating the band; "Add Subject" Title Case; Title Case tabs; three control rows; "Find the employee" repeated on all eight rows (confirmed at runtime); the clipped Actions column seen in the older screenshot set was not reproduced at 1440px. Fixed: PageChrome names the screen once as "Teaching staff", the Title Case is gone, the HR badge is itself the link to the record, "Find the employee" is a row-menu verb shown only where there is no employee to find, and the row verbs are a menu. The band chips, the tabs, the three control rows and the profile-flags column stand	Three tabs, three deletes — the deletes now read as archiving with a way back; subjects CRUD here and in master data	gated	renderer ×3 (good)	P2 (was P1)
/schools/teachers/assignments	teacher-assignments-content.tsx	PageChrome (good); "Take it off them" copy is right	Bulk allocate lives on the teachers page instead	gated	no renderer	P2
/schools/time table	schools-time-table-content.tsx (925 lines)	PageHeading plus a two-line description; three buttons in a section header with the primary greyed; filters across two rows with the search orphaned; empty-state prose defining a lesson	Placing a lesson is a sheet with six pickers; no click-a-cell, no drag; clashes are a chip	useSchoolAccess used	at 390px the warning banner is 190px, then five stacked selects; grid below the fold	P1

Route	Component	Contract violations	Friction	Role awareness	Phone	Severity
/schools/imports	schools-import-content.tsx	PageHeading plus description; step 3 re-renders step 2's mapping above the results; "Earlier imports" always under the wizard with a pager for one row	Column mapping and rejection copy are the best in the module; Undo exists here and nowhere else	useSchoolAccess used	"Check the columns" heading wraps to three lines beside a paragraph	P2
/schools/documents	school-documents-content.tsx (938 lines)	"School Documents", "Report Cards / Fee Invoices / Class Lists / Attendance Registers", "Select Student", "Student No", "Invoice No" all Title Case; raw enum status printed. Fixed: PageChrome names it "Documents" once, the tabs and labels are sentence case, and the rationale and stat cards above them are gone	Pupil → preview → print is three clicks; batch by class only for lists and registers; four of eight sources missing; and a report card now fails outright at a school with no open publish window, which is every school (workflows.md B14)	not gated (fine)	no renderer; fixed-width preview	P1
/schools/transport	transport-content.tsx (1,389 lines)	PageChrome (good); four variant="primary" buttons; three band CreateButtons; six explanatory paragraphs	"Put a child on the bus" is two clicks and four selects; the morning register is a good pattern	gated	no renderer	P1
/schools/library, /library/loans	library-content.tsx, library-loans-content.tsx	PageChrome (good); both register the app-bar title "Library", fixed: the loans screen registers "Library loans"; two primaries each	Lending is three pickers; no barcode or accession quick entry; "Fines if back today" chip is good	gated	no renderer	P1
/schools/boarding/hostels	boarding-hostels-content.tsx, hostel-room-s-panel.tsx	Title flips between "Hostels" and the hostel's name on one route; Rooms and Beds sub-tabs plus a Properties card plus a bed-board card: three tables on one view; two primaries	Beds per room dialog; no "add 24 beds numbered 1 to 24"	gated	one renderer hit	P1

Route	Component	Contract violations	Friction	Role awareness	Phone	Severity
/schools/notices	schools-notices-content.tsx	"School Notices" Title Case; side card "A notice cannot be recalled" (:576-579) rendered as UI; toLocaleString ×6. Fixed: the rationale card is gone and Page Chrome names it "Notices"	No schedule, draft or recall	gated	none	P2 (was P0; the copy leak is gone)
/schools/messages	office-inbox-content.tsx	PageHeading plus description; assign-dialog description is rationale	This audit was wrong to record a reply in the page. There was none. The screen's own header comment put starting and replying with the family and the teacher in their own portals, and the route carried no reply action for anybody, so the office could route a fee question to a teacher who cannot read the ledger, or end the conversation, and nothing else. A reply composer now sits in the reading dialog, gated on schools.reports reply and hidden rather than refused for a reader without the grant and on an ended conversation (workflow.md B15). "End the conversation" confirm is good; still no unread badge in nav	gated	none: an inbox with no phone shell	P1

3. Screenshot findings

- **Subjects list (records-desktop).** Four levels of navigation (school sidebar, Settings rail, Master Data rail, page tabs) before the table, a description line, chips, stacked filters, a floating primary and a third control row. Mono codes as links and Core/Elective badges are good. The first of those four levels has gone: the school rail reaches this page directly from a Setup band. The Settings and Master Data rails, the description line, the chips, the stacked filters and the third control row are all still there.

- **Classes.** Two navigation rails plus the sidebar; "The year-group ladder and the streams inside each one." as a description; chips and tabs duplicated; "New class" floating at the right of the second filter; a third control row; "Capacity -"; pagination for six rows; a 740px table in a 1440px window. Reachable from the school rail now; nothing else in this paragraph has changed.
- **Teachers and teacher-HR.** Identity cell with mono id and email (good). Heading, caption and bar title; "Add Subject" in Title Case; three control rows; "Find the employee" eight times. The runtime capture shows the primary in the bar and no clipped column, so the older screenshot predates a fix. The repeated button has since gone with it: the HR badge is the link, and "Find the employee" is a row-menu verb on a teacher who has no employee. The heading and caption are one `PageChrome` title and the Title Case is swept; the three control rows stand.
- **Timetable (desktop and phone).** "No periods yet" banner with a real next step (good). Two-line description; three section-header buttons with the primary greyed; filters split over two rows with the search orphaned; nothing to click to place a lesson; on the phone, description, three buttons, a 190px banner with a wrapped button, then five stacked selects; no grid. Unchanged, except that the route now has a skeleton drawing the week grid with the days as headers rather than a list of rows.
- **Imports (desktop and phone).** Column chips, "did you mean", and "could be 3 April or 4 March — write it as YYYY-MM-DD" are the best copy in the module. Step 3 shows step 2's form again; "Earlier imports" always under the wizard; a dry run's "Not imported" badge reads as failure. On the phone the card header wraps to three lines beside a five-line paragraph.
- **Teachers on a phone.** Cards read well ("TCH-001 · Mathematics · No HR record · HOD · Class teacher"), but heading, caption, full-width primary, chips, band buttons, clipped tabs, two selects, search, Search, Columns/Export precede the first card at $y \approx 610$. The heading and caption are one title now; the rest of that stack is as it was.

4. Rule violations that recur

Rule	Violation	Where
A page is named once	<code>MasterDataShell</code> or <code>PageHeading</code> plus the bar title	all six master-data pages, timetable, imports, messages; fixed on teachers, documents and notices
One primary in the bar	Two or more primaries; primary floating in the page	years, subjects, calendar, timetable, transport, library, loans, hostels
One control row, one search	Stacked filters, floating create, a third row	classes, subjects, periods, grading, teachers
Never the same fact twice	Chips duplicating tabs	classes, subjects, teachers
Row verbs in a menu	Clipped actions column; identical per-row button	teachers; fixed, the verbs are a menu and the repeated button is gone
Sentence case	Title Case and ALL CAPS	the six master-data page titles; fixed on documents, notices, teachers, years and boarding
Dates as <code>3 June 2026</code>	Native date inputs	calendar, timetable, imports, documents
Strip explanatory copy	Descriptions under every title; paragraphs under controls; prose empty states	most setup screens; fixed on documents, notices and the oversight boards, where the rationale cards and the stat cards repeating band chips are gone

Rule	Violation	Where
One table per view	Three tables on the hostel page	hostels
Distinct app-bar titles	"Library" twice	library, loans; fixed, the loans bar reads "Library loans"
Table becomes cards below md	No renderer	staff, assignments, documents, transport, library, loans, notices, messages
Progressive disclosure	Wizard grows instead of advancing	imports

5. Suggested edits

P0

1. Remove the rationale card from notices (`schools-notices-content.tsx:576-582`). Done, and with it the rationale cards and the stat cards repeating band chips on the other back-office screens that drew them.
2. Bring the Setup band into the school sidebar (see workflows B1) so these screens are reachable in one rail. Done. The band links across to the pages where they are; they still open in the Management shell, so item 3 below stands in full.

P1 3. Replace `MasterDataShell` descriptions and `PageHeadings` with `PageChrome` (pass `description={undefined}` in `app/management/master-data/schools/*/page.tsx` as the minimum); move the create verb into the bar; delete captions that repeat chips. Done on teachers, documents and notices; not done on the six master-data pages, which still carry a Title Case shell title and a description. 4. Wrap filters in `TableControls` with `actions=` and remove the `DataTable`'s internal search on classes, subjects, periods, grading and teachers, so each screen has one control row and one search. 5. Teachers: fold HR RECORD into a badge that is the link; move "Find the employee" into the row menu or a band action "Link 8 teachers to HR"; `layout="menu"` on the actions; hide PROFILE FLAGS by default. Done but for the last: the profile-flags column is still shown, in sentence case. 6. Timetable: bar primary "Add lesson"; band actions "Build the week" and "Copy forward"; one control row; the grid is the surface with `+` targets in empty cells that open the lesson sheet pre-filled; clashes as red cells; hide "Build timetable" when there are no periods and let the banner carry the requirement. 7. Title Case sweep: `school-documents-content.tsx:687, 770-773, 782, 267-272, 406-411`; `schools-notices-content.tsx:369`; `boarding-allocations-content.tsx:258, 294-298, 338, 388`; `boarding-leave-content.tsx:214-215, 223`; `schools-teachers-content.tsx:660, 715`; `schools-years-content.tsx:78, 90`. Done for all six files. The Title Case that remains is in the `MasterDataShell` titles the page files pass, which this list did not reach. 8. Native dates to the design-system picker (sheet on phone) across the 18 files. 9. Library loans: app-bar title "Library loans". Done. 10. Hostels: list and record on separate routes; one table per tab. 11. Phone renderers for staff, assignments, documents, transport, library, loans, notices, messages. 12. Explanatory paragraphs: keep only those that carry a changing number, as a band chip. Done on the back-office boards, where a card carrying a number kept the number as a chip and lost the prose; the descriptions under the setup titles are untouched.

P2 13. Imports: collapse completed steps to a one-line summary with "Change"; move "Earlier imports" behind a tab; label a dry run "Checked, nothing written". 14. Periods: "Generate periods" (start, length, count, breaks). 15. Beds: "Add N beds numbered from X". 16. Terms: "Add three terms" template when creating a year. 17. Identity settings: design-system save bar with a dirty indicator; copy its role alert pattern to every setup page.

6. Proposed restructuring

- **Setup as one band in the school shell** (`/schools/setup/*`): Years and terms, Calendar, Classes and streams, Subjects, School day and rooms, Grading and publish windows, Records and identity, Fee structures (link), Staff (link). One rail, `PageChrome` titles, no descriptions.
- **Master data ordered as imports need it**, with a readiness strip at the top of the band's landing page (see §7).
- **One home per entity**: subjects, publish windows and assignments each on one screen; the other pages link.
- **Teachers page split**: a Teachers list (profiles, HR link status, portal status) and an Allocation screen (bulk allocation, assignments); subjects go to Setup.
- **Accounts screen** under People: portal status per person, invite, resend, reset, disable.
- **Documents becomes a document centre** with all eight sources, batch by class, template per school, print queue.

7. Proposed new UI

Setup readiness (`/schools/setup`)

- Hero: Setup completeness, "7 of 10 steps", with the checklist in import order; done rows collapse; each row links to its screen.
- KPIs (two-up on phone): Teachers without an HR record; Teachers without a portal sign-in; Classes without a form teacher; Subjects with no teacher allocated.
- Queues: "Not yet set up" (rooms, periods, windows); "Data quality" (pupils not in a class, guardians without a phone, duplicate applications); "Imports" (last run, rejected rows, Undo).
- A school-year timeline strip: terms, holidays and publish windows on one line.

Timetable builder: the week grid as the working surface; class, teacher and room views; cell click to place, drag to move, clash highlighting; "Build the week" preview showing what will be placed and what cannot; exam mode later.

Account administration: a table of people with portal status (Invited, Claimed, Never signed in, Disabled), channel (email, phone), last sign-in; bulk invite by class with a delivery report; per-row resend and reset.

Interaction patterns to add: bulk actions (invite, link to HR, activate structures); ⌘K verbs ("New class", "Open the timetable for Form 3"); inline quick-edit for one-field changes (form teacher, capacity, pass mark); URL-synced filters; undo toasts for archive and delete; requirement banners as the only disabled state; route-level `loading.tsx`, `error.tsx`, `not-found.tsx`. The last of these has landed across `app/schools`: a skeleton, a client error boundary wired to its own reset and quoting the digest, and a not-found; where a route's shape is distinctive the skeleton mirrors it, so the timetable is a week grid and the record pages are the two-column property rail they actually draw, and the three class routes that call `notFound()` send the reader back to the list they came from. Nothing below the segment root carries its own boundary, deliberately. The six master-data pages under Management have none of this. Of the bulk actions, only a Remind shipped, on the fees ledger: bulk issue, print, activate and approve have no endpoint behind them and were deliberately

not faked by fanning out requests from the browser, so bulk invite, bulk link to HR and activating structures in a batch wait on the same thing.

8. Accessibility

- Clipped actions on teachers are unreachable by keyboard; the menu fixes it. The menu has since landed, and the repeated per-row button with it.
- Native date inputs announce in the browser locale and render US order; the picker fixes format and announcement.
- Title Case and ALL CAPS group headers are read letter by letter by some screen readers.
- Icon-only buttons in the import stepper and the timetable grid need names; the greyed primary needs its requirement as visible text, not a `title`.
- The identity page's read-only alert is the right pattern: it tells the reader why controls are inert and who can change them.